

The Dhāraṇī of the Ritual of the Noble Vajrapāṇi Who Wears the Blue Garment

Ārya-Nīlāmbaṛadhara-Vajrapāṇi-Kalpa-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 748 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ལག་ན་རྩོམ་གྱིས་སྒྲོ་པ་ཅན་གྱི་ཞེ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའུ་གི་ཟུངས།

Toh 748 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-Nīlāmbaṛadhara-Vajrapāṇi-Kalpa-nāma-dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as the Phakpa Lakna Dorjé Gö Ngönpochen Gyi Choga Shyepa'i Zung, rendered in English as "The Dhāraṇī Called 'The Ritual of the Noble Vajrapāṇi Who Wears the Blue Garment.'" It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and centers on a fearsome, wrathful form of Vajrapāṇi — the great chieftain of the yakṣas — who is adorned with serpents, whose eyes blaze like fire, and who is endowed with the nāga lord's jewels, making him a powerful protector invoked through sacred mantra and ritual. The text opens with a vivid homage that vividly evokes this deity's terrifying splendor and his authorization by countless buddhas, establishing the devotional and ritual context for the dhāraṇī that follows.

In the language of India: Ārya-Nīlāmbaṛadhara-Vajrapāṇi-Kalpa-nāma-dhāraṇī.
In the language of Tibet: The dhāraṇī called "The Ritual of the Noble Vajrapāṇi Who Wears the Blue Garment."

Homage to the Three Jewels.

Homage to Vajrapāṇi, the great chieftain of the yakṣas, who wears the blue garment, who has been authorized by buddhas as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges River; whose fangs are bared and shining; whose eyes are like blazing masses of fire; whose breath blazes like a tongue of flame; whose voice rings with terror; whose hands and feet are adorned with the wealth-jewels of the nāga lord; who holds a black nāga as a topknot; who wears as earrings the blazing nāgas Nandaka and Upanandaka; who wears a precious crown of blazing serpents; who devours venomous blazing serpents; whose face is broad; whose brows and forehead are drawn together; whose upper lip is pressed down; who bears the form of Yama, lord of death; whose tongue flickers like lightning, great-bellied, devouring serpents; who strikes terror with the clap of his hands; who is girded at the waist with Takṣaka, king of nāgas; who lets out the great cry "A-la-la!"; who, though the ocean's depth extends eighty thousand leagues, walks upon it only to his knees; who bears Indra and the sun upon his shoulders; who causes the destruction of all nāgas by laughing a great booming laugh that throws everything into turmoil; who,

bearing the form of Yama, lord of death, strikes terror through all three realms and binds the nāgas.

Then recite this awareness-mantra spoken by the Blessed One, the Buddha, in a number equal to the grains of sand of the Ganges River:

Tadyathā — Bho bho vāṇanāgādhipate, idaṃ nīlāmbaradhara śarīraṃ, vajrapāṇi-hṛdayaṃ yaḥ, samātikramath, utsādanaṃ bhaviṣyati. Tadyathā — Buddha buddha, vibuddha vibuddha, mahīprāpta, hara hara nāgānāṃ, prahara prahara nāgānāṃ, chinda chinda nāga-hṛdayāni, bhinda bhinda nāga-marmāṇi, bhīṣīryantu nāga-śarīrāṇi, visphōṭaya nāga-nayanāni. Tadyathā — Hūṃ phaṭ. Nāga-vidāraṇāya phaṭ. Nāgotsādanāya phaṭ. Nīlāmbasanāya phaṭ. Apratihata-bala-parākramāya phaṭ. Kṛtāntāya phaṭ. Kṛtānta-rūpāya phaṭ. Roṣaṇāya phaṭ. Trāsanāya phaṭ. Kumbhāṇḍotsādanāya phaṭ. Preta-piśāci-vināśakarāya phaṭ. Yakṣāpasmāra-vināśakarāya phaṭ. Hasa hasa, dāra dāra, māraya māraya, nāśaya nāśaya, sarva-vighnaṃ vināśakarāya phaṭ. Sarva-śatrūṇ saṃgha-vināśakarāya phaṭ. Oṃ nīvāṃbara-dhara-vajrapāṇi, rājñāpayati svāhā.

For the ritual applications of this dhāraṇī: for one seized by a yakṣa, the mantra is to be applied to water which is then sprinkled upon the person, and he will be freed. To repel nāgas, one should use the tip of a white mustard-wood twig or a twig of a Nepalese pepper plant. For hungry ghosts and those who cause forgetfulness, one should use cord. To prevent epidemic illness, for pain in the side, and for one bitten by a mouse, one should use a blue cord. If one desires wealth, one should fast for a single day, burn incense with a censer, and in a dream all beneficial and harmful matters will be revealed, and seven thousand gold coins will be given. To break a seal, one should use ash. To open an iron lock, one should use white mustard. To protect against all fears, one should use rancid butter, ash, or white mustard. For all fears of illness, a protective knot should be tied in a blue cord and fastened around the neck: this will become the supreme protection. For a child threatened by spirits, a protective knot should be tied in a five-colored cord and fastened around the neck: this will become the supreme protection. To repel thieves, one should use earth. For poison, one should apply kuśa grass.

For protecting oneself, one should use the mind or water. For protecting others, one should use a blue cord. For all these rites, the mantra is to be recited three times, or seven, or fourteen, or twenty-one, or one hundred and eight times. Performed in this way, it will be accomplished.

Before a stūpa enshrining sacred relics, one should make an offering of blue flowers and recite the mantra one thousand times: it will be accomplished.

Here ends the dhāraṇī called The Ritual of Noble Vajrapāṇi of the Blue Robe.

From the Indian master Dīpaṃkara Śrījñāna and

Translator's Notes

- The Sanskrit mantra is transliterated from Tibetan phonetic rendering and has been reconstructed as closely as possible to intelligible Sanskrit. Some syllables in the mantra body are ritual vocables without straightforward Sanskrit etymology; the transliteration reflects the Tibetan as faithfully as possible rather than over-normalizing.

The term rendered "awareness-mantra" is rig sngags (vidyāmantra), the standard Tibetan rendering of Sanskrit vidyā in its mantra-dhāraṇī sense.

The phrase rendered "Nepalese pepper plant" translates bal po'i se'u, referring to a plant associated with Nepal; precise botanical identification is uncertain but it is conventionally glossed as a species of pepper or similar shrub.

The rendering "mouse-bite" for yig 'chus pa is tentative; the term literally means "gnawed by a mouse" but some commentators take it more broadly as any rodent-inflicted wound.

- The passage ends mid-sentence with the colophon naming the Indian master Dīpaṃkara Śrījñāna (Atiśa), indicating the translation team attribution continues in the following line. This is a standard Tibetan canonical colophon formula and the abrupt ending is faithful to the source passage as given.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.